

Harmel and Janda 1994 RG Notes

Harmel, Robert, and Kenneth Janda. “An Integrated Theory of Party Goals and Party Change” [1994].

Journal of Theoretical Politics 6(3): 259-287.

Party change results from one of three sources:

- 1) leadership change
- 2) a change of dominant faction within the party
- 3) an external stimulus for change

Very similar to the EVL framework from Clark et al 2017, at least in highlighting *why* the scenario at hand might change

Previous literature often suggests volatility or exogenous decline; here, suggested that a series of behaviors, changes, and actions are necessary to meaningfully influence party direction

Three primary premises of the theory:

- 1) Each party has a primary goal which can vary both across party and across time. (This is a quick link to Policy/Office/Votes by Strom 1990 and Muller/Strom 1999)
- 2) Dramatic change occurs after shocks: parties are conservative organizations in that they will not substantially change without good cause
- 3) External shocks = “external stimuli that impact on the party’s primary goal” – this can change across parties based on their goal. For example, regime change may affect policy-driven parties much more than ideology-driven parties or electorally-driven parties

Adds a fourth goal beyond Strom 1990: “Implementing Party Democracy”, or “democracy-seeking.” Parties can be motivated by a desire to be democratic themselves, though this is not necessarily a given. (This is a huge contribution to the reading list even though it is only briefly mentioned here)